

Knee and Lower Leg Conditions Disability Benefits Questionnaire

SYNTHETIC REPLICA for software testing. Structure follows VA Form 21-0960M-9. All data fictional.

Form number	21-0960M-9
Veteran name	Leilani K. Ahuna
Date of birth	01/16/1990
SSN	900-45-6789
Date of examination	08/12/2026
Examiner	Dr. A. Fictional, MD
Knee examined	☒ Right ☐ Left

Section 1. Diagnosis

Diagnosis #1	Right knee strain with chondromalacia patella
ICD code	M22.41

Section 2. Medical history

History (onset, course, treatment)	Veteran reports right knee pain beginning in service after a fall during a field exercise in 2011, treated conservatively. Symptoms have
------------------------------------	--

Section 3. Flare-ups

Does the Veteran report flare-ups?	☒ Yes ☐ No
Describe (frequency, duration, severity, functional loss)	

Section 4. Functional loss or impairment

Functional loss or impairment reported?	☒ Yes ☐ No
Describe	Difficulty with prolonged standing, squatting, and stairs.

Section 5. Initial range of motion (ROM) measurements

Normal knee ROM: flexion 0 to 140 degrees; extension 140 to 0 degrees (38 CFR 4.71, Plate II).

Flexion (0-140), degrees

Extension (140-0), degrees short of 0

Is ROM abnormal or outside normal range?

☒ Yes ☐ No

If abnormal, does ROM contribute to functional loss?

☒ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not addressed

Is pain noted on examination (on ROM)?

☒ Yes ☐ No

Does the pain cause functional loss?

☒ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not addressed

Evidence of pain with weight-bearing?

☒ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not tested

Evidence of pain in nonweight-bearing?

☒ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not tested

Evidence of pain on passive ROM testing?

☒ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not tested

If not tested, explain

Objective evidence of localized tenderness or pain on palpation?

☒ Yes ☐ No

Objective evidence of crepitus?

☒ Yes ☐ No

Is the opposing joint undamaged?

☒ Yes ☐ No

Opposing joint flexion, degrees

Opposing joint extension, degrees

Section 6. Repetitive-use testing

Was repetitive-use testing (3 repetitions) performed?

☒ Yes ☐ No

If not performed, explain

Flexion after 3 repetitions, degrees

Extension after 3 repetitions, degrees

Additional loss of function or ROM after repetitions?

☒ Yes ☐ No

Section 7. Flare-ups and repeated use over time

Is the examination being conducted during a flare-up?

☐ Yes ☐ No

Do pain, weakness, fatigability or incoordination significantly limit functional ability during flare-ups?

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unable to say without...

Estimated flexion during flare-ups, degrees

Estimated extension during flare-ups, degrees

If unable to estimate, explain

Contributing factors of disability (check all that apply):

- ☒ Pain on movement
- ☐ Weakened movement
- ☒ Excess fatigability
- ☐ Incoordination
- ☒ Less movement than normal
- ☐ Swelling
- ☐ Atrophy of disuse
- ☐ Instability of station

Section 9. Muscle strength testing

Knee flexion strength (0/5 - 5/5)

Knee extension strength (0/5 - 5/5)

Muscle atrophy?

☐ Yes ☐ No

Section 10. Ankylosis

Ankylosis of the knee?

☐ Yes ☐ No

Section 11. Joint stability tests

Anterior instability (Lachman test)

☐ Normal ☐ 1+ ☐ 2+ ☐ 3+
☐ Not tested

Posterior instability (posterior drawer test)

☐ Normal ☐ 1+ ☐ 2+ ☐ 3+
☐ Not tested

Medial instability (valgus pressure)

☐ Normal ☐ 1+ ☐ 2+ ☐ 3+
☐ Not tested

Lateral instability (varus pressure)

☐ Normal ☐ 1+ ☐ 2+ ☐ 3+
☐ Not tested

History of recurrent subluxation

☐ None ☐ Slight ☐ Moderate ☐ Severe

History of lateral instability

☐ None ☐ Slight ☐ Moderate ☐ Severe
Section 11b. Ligament and patellar instability (DC 5257, 2021 criteria)

Ligament injury (cruciate or collateral)

☐ None ☐ Sprain ☐ Incomplete tear
☐ Complete tear

If a tear: repair status

☐ N/A ☐ Repaired ☐ Unrepaired
☐ Failed repair

Does the injury cause persistent instability?

☐ Yes ☐ No

Has a medical provider prescribed bracing for ambulation?

☐ Yes ☐ No

Assistive device prescribed by a medical provider for ambulation

☐ None ☐ Cane ☐ Crutches ☐ Walker

Diagnosed patellofemoral complex condition with recurrent patellar instability?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes: history of surgical repair of the patellofemoral complex?

☐ Yes ☐ No

Section 18. Diagnostic testing

Imaging studies performed and reviewed?

☒ Yes ☐ No

Degenerative or traumatic arthritis documented?

☐ Yes ☒ No

Section 19. Functional impact

Impact on ability to work

The knee condition limits prolonged standing and walking; the Veteran can perform sedentary work with position changes.

Section 20. Remarks

Remarks, if any

Additional loss of 15 degrees of flexion after three repetitions due to pain and fatigability.

Medical opinion (if requested)

Was a medical opinion requested?

☒ Yes ☐ No

Opinion

☒ At least as likely as... ☐ Less likely than not ...
☐ Cannot be determined ...

Rationale

The current right knee condition is at least as likely as not related to the documented in-service fall because the service treatment reco